

Part I

Writing

(30 minutes)

Directions: *For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay that begins with the sentence “**Nowadays** parents are increasingly aware that allowing kids more freedom to explore and learn on their own helps them gain independence and boost their confidence.” You can make comments, cite examples or use your own experiences to develop your essay. You should write at least 150 words but no more than 200 words (not including the sentence given).*

Part IV

Translation

(30 minutes)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on *Answer Sheet 2*.

随着经济与社会的发展，中国人口结构发生了显著变化，逐渐步入老龄化社会。中国老年人口将持续增加，人口老龄化趋势将更加明显。为了应对人口老龄化带来的种种挑战，国家正积极采取措施，加强养老的支持。通过改革社会保障 (social security) 制度，政府不断增加社会保障经费，逐步扩大社会保障覆盖范围，使更多老年人受益。政府还鼓励各种社会团体为老年人提供服务。在政府和社会团体共同努力下，老年人将生活得更加幸福。